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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCE

EXAMINATION APRIL 2026

SECOND SEMESTER

Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) - MG2MDCPSY100 -PSYCHOLOGY OF FRIENDSHIP AND LOVE

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Maximum Marks: 50

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

PartA

Multiple Choice Question- Choose the most appropriate answer

Answer all questions

Each question carries 1 marks

1. The tendency to over- attribute people's behaviour to their personalities rather than to their situation is called: [U] / [C01]

a) Negativity Bias b) Positivity Bias c) Cognitive Dissonance **d)Fundamental Attribution Error**

2. What term is used to refer the Homosexual males? [K] / [CO1}

a) Gay b) Lesbian c) Trans men d) Trans sexualism

3. What does the matching hypothesis state? {K] / [C01]

a) Opposites attract. b) Physical appearance does not matter **c) People with similar levels of attractiveness form relationships** d) Relationships are based purely on— personality.

4. What is a key factor in developing online intimacy? [A] / [C02]

a) Avoiding emotional sharing **b) Self-disclosure due to sense of anonymity** c) Distrust d) Physical appearance

5. Which of the following best helps long-term couples avoid boredom? [U] / [C01]

a). Focusing on shared responsibilities b). Avoiding conflict ¢). Maintaining consistent routines **d). Introducing novelty into the relationship**

6. According to Donn Byrne's two-stage model, how do people typically choose romantic partners? [U] / [CO1]

a) They first seek out people who are different from them. **b) They initially avoid those who appear dissimilar and then choose from those who are most similar.** c) They prioritize personality-similarity over all other factors. d) They randomly select partners based on attraction alone.

7. Which of the following is a common pattern seen in dissatisfied couples during conflict? [U] / [CO2}

a) Aggression-acceptance b) Silent treatment **c) Demand-withdraw** d) Shared avoidance

8. What is the term for passion alone, according to the Triangular theory of love? [(U] / [CO1}]

a). Romantic love b). Fatuous love c). Consummate love **d) Infatuation**

9. The willingness to give up resentment, negative judgment, and indifference toward the transgressor and to give undeserved compassion, generosity, and benevolence to him or her is known as: (K] / [CO3]

a) Forgiveness b) Vengeance c) Retribution d) Condemnation

10. What is sexism? [U] / [CO3

a). Discrimination based on age **b) Discrimination based on gender** C). Discrimination based on race d) Discrimination based on social Class

11. Which of the following is an example of fondness? [U]/[CO3]

a) Feeling angry with a friend for not returning a favor b) Feeling excited to meet a new person **c) Feeling a strong bond with a family member** d) Feeling disappointed with a romantic partner

12. A conscious process that requires moment to moment effort is called--- [K]/[CO4]

a). Mindfulness b). Attraction c). Reciprocal liking d)Minding

13. "What does research suggest about gender differences in communication? [An]/CO3]

a). Females talk more than males **b) Males talk more than females** c) There is no difference in communication styles d) Females interrupt more than males

14, Why do some men hesitate to seek psychological help? [K]/[CO3]

a). They fear being seen as weak b). They receive strong social encouragement c). Therapy is always unaffordable d). They do not experience mental health struggles

15. Which type of conflict arises due to internal dilemmas or struggles? [K]/[CO4]

a) Interpersonal Conflict b) Organizational Conflict **c) Intrapersonal Conflict**
d) Community Conflict

16. What is an exception to the general finding of no gender differences in mathematical abilities? [An]/CO3]

a) Boys outperform girls in mathematical computations. b) Girls outperform boys in mathematical problem-solving. **c) Boys start to slightly outperform girls in mathematical complex problem solving in high school** d) Girls take more high school math and physics courses than boys.

17. What is a characteristic of indirect aggression? [An]/CO3]

a). It involves direct confrontation with the target b). It involves physical harm to the target. **c) It involves covert behaviors where the target is not directly confronted** d). It involves verbal insults.

18. What kind of self-disclosure leads to feelings of intimacy? [K] / [CO3]

a) Factual-descriptive self-disclosures (e.g., "I have three siblings") **b) Emotional-evaluative self-disclosures (e.g., "I feel close to my sister")** c) Self-disclosures that focus on facts, not feelings d) Self-disclosures about personal hobbies

19. What kind of reactions do rejection-sensitive individuals tend to exhibit when they perceive rejection? [U] / [CO2]

a). Calm and reflective responses **b) Jealousy, hostility, and aggression** c) Indifference and detachment d). Acceptance and understanding

20. Which type of relationship did the smallest percentage of college students identify as their closest? [K] / [CO1]

a) Romantic partner b) Friend c) Family member **d) Co-worker**

[1x20 = 20]

Part B

Short Answer

Answer any 10 questions

Each question carries 3 marks [3x10 = 30]

21. Why do some people stay in unsatisfying relationships, according to Interdependence Theory? [U] / [C01]

A: Interdependence or social exchange theory postulates that interpersonal relationships are governed by perceptions of the rewards and costs exchanged in interactions – if needs or expectations are unmet or misperceptions, can lead to unsatisfied relationship, but still people tend to stay due to emotional dependence, high investment on the relationship, prefer a familiar unsatisfying situation over an uncertain future hoping that things will change for better.

22. How does social media affect friendships in real life? [A] / [CO2]

A: Reduced face-to-face interaction may weaken real-life social skills, Misunderstandings arise as text-based communication can cause confusion or conflicts, Jealousy and comparison that may create insecurity or unnecessary competition, Superficial relationships may develop through online platforms that lack emotional depth. (students may write on their own, relevance to the question matters)

23. Explain the role of proximity in the development of attraction. ([U] /[CO1]

A: Proximity – the geographic, residential, and other forms of spatial closeness - in everyday life people become attracted to, and acquainted with, someone who lives or works nearby – as it is more helpful to find out their similarities & may be seen as more convenient and less costly (in terms of time and energy) - someone in close proximity becomes familiar to them.

24. Discuss the topic "Romantic love as an attachment". [U] / [C01]

A: The influence of early (childhood) attachment pattern on adult romantic relationship, how various attachment styles (secure, anxious, avoidant) shapes adult romantic relationship & their characteristics with consequences

25. Men tend to self-disclose personal information less than women. What do you think are the factors that lead to such inhibitions even in close friendships? [U] / [C01]

A: Men's lower levels of self-disclosure in close friendships are often explained through socio-cultural factors rather than an inability to feel deeply. Men are socially expected to be emotionally & physically strong, independent, successful, less expressive, authoritative & decision makers. As a result, expressing emotions & sharing personal informations, or emotional dependence may feel inconsistent with masculine identity. Men may worry that disclosure will make them appear weak.

26. Why is defining the conflict as a mutual problem important for constructive resolution? [A] / [CO4]

A: conflict is viewed as a mutual problem to be solved as effectively as possible - encourages openness and honesty - stresses the importance of criticizing the ideas of other person in a disagreement rather than criticizing the other person as a whole - clarify differences and similarities in positions - produce trust after the conflict. This conflict management strategy is known as COLLABORATION (high concern for self and others) **-** the most productive approach that will optimally satisfy both parties

27. How can avoiding conflict be beneficial at times? [An] / [CO4]

A: Some people simply find conflict as extremely negative. When a conflict emerges, the avoider will change the subject, mask the discussion with humor, make a quick exit, or pretend to be busy with something else. Usually, people who prefer this style hope that ignoring a problem will make it go away. For minor problems, this tactic is often a good one—there's no need to react to every little problem.

28. What is economic discrimination? [U] / [C03]

A: Women are victimized by two forms of economic discrimination: differential access to jobs and differential treatment once on the job –lack the same employment opportunities as men. Across all economic sectors, men are more likely than women to hold positions with decision-making authority - motherhood can be a liability on the job market. Women typically earn lower salaries than men in the same jobs. When women demonstrate leadership qualities they are evaluated less favorably than men, because this behavior contradicts the female gender stereotype. (May also include) ***Glass ceiling effect:*** prevents most women and ethnic minorities from being advanced to top-level professional positions. ***Glass escalator effect:*** men employed are promoted more quickly than their female counterparts

29. Define juggling multiple roles of females. [U] / [C03]

A: The gap between workplace policies and the reality shows that women who "want it all" experience burdens and conflicts, because most women have major day-to-day responsibilities in *three* roles: spouse, parent, and worker – because of this, they either sacrifice the worker role or accept whatever income they get thus to feel less stress to rear young children - A strategy known as "You can have it all, just not all at the same time" - problem stems from the tensions among these roles and the unequal sharing of role responsibilities.

30. Discuss the main findings of Petersen and Hyde's meta-analysis (2010, 2011) regarding gender differences in sexual behavior and attitudes. [An] / [CO3]

A: Their work is strongly associated with the Gender Similarities Hypothesis. This supported the idea that men and women share many similar sexual motivations and experiences. Gender differences in sexuality exist, but they are generally much smaller than stereotypes portray, and they are shaped significantly by social and cultural contexts rather than biology alone. According to gender role expectations men are expected to be more knowledgeable regarding sexual behavior than women.

31. What is effective listening? [K]/[CO3]

A: An active skill & a mindful activity with complex process requiring one to select and organize information, interpret and respond to communications, and recall what was heard- (may also include) shows interest in the speaker via nonverbal cues- Hear the other person out before responding- paraphrase what you believe the speaker said - ask for clarification.

32. What are the five styles of managing conflict, and how do they differ? [K]/[CO4]

A: AVOIDANCE- **(low concern for self and others)**- views conflict as negative - a conflict emerges, the avoider will change the subject, mask the discussion with humor, make a quick exit, or pretend to be busy with something else hoping that ignoring a problem will make it go away. For minor problems – it is a good one - no need to react to every little problem. For bigger conflicts - not a good strategy - delays the solution.

ACCOMODATION **(low concern for self, high concern for others) -** views conflict as negative - brings the conflict to a quick end by giving in easily - People who are overly concerned about acceptance and approval from others commonly use this strategy- does not make creative thinking and effective solutions - feelings of anger (on both sides) may develop because the accommodator often likes to play the role of a martyr

COMPETING **(high concern for self, low concern for others) -** views conflict as a win-or-lose situation - will do anything to emerge victorious from conflicts - they can be aggressive, rigidly stick to one position, use threats to force the other party to submit - fails to generate creative solutions to problems, likely to lead to tension, anger, and hostility after the conflict

COMPROMISE **(moderate concern for self and others) -** practical approach to conflict - acknowledges the different needs of both persons- willing to negotiate and to meet the other person's need almost, each person gives up something so both can have partial satisfaction. a fairly constructive approach to conflict because both persons gain some satisfaction, especially when the issue is moderately important.

COLLABORATION **(high concern for self and others) -** the most productive approach that will optimally satisfy both parties - conflict is viewed as a mutual problem to be solved as effectively as possible - encourages openness and honesty - stresses the importance of criticizing the ideas of other person in a disagreement rather than criticizing the other person as a whole - clarify differences and similarities in positions - produce trust after the conflict

33. Create a step-by-step plan to develop assertive communication skills. [C]/CO4]

A: assertive communication - acting in one's own best interests by expressing one's thoughts and feelings directly and honestly, without offending others. Steps in assertiveness training (5 steps): understand what assertive communication is, monitor your assertive communication across various situations, observe a model's assertive communication, practice assertive communication (covert rehearsal, role play), adopt an assertive attitude (students may develop a plan using this information)